interested parties such as cargo owners, insurers and salvage interests. It is also essential that both the ship's Plan and its company's shoreside Plan are co-ordinated to guarantee that all parties having an interest are advised and that duplication of reports is avoided.
2.5 Steps to control discharge
2.5.1 Ship personnel will almost always be in the best position to take quick action to mitigate or control the discharge of oil from their ship. The Plan should provide the master with clear guidance on how to accomplish this

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
2.5.1 Ship personnel will almost always be in the best position to take quick action to mitigate or control the discharge of oil from their ship. The Plan should provide the master with clear guidance on how to accomplish this mitigation for a variety of situations. The Plan should not only outline action to be taken, but it should also identify who on board is responsible so that confusion during the emergency can be avoided.
2.5.2 This section of the Plan will vary widely from ship to ship. Differences in ship type, construction, cargo, equipment, manning, and even route may result in shifting emphasis being placed on various aspects of this section. As a minimum, the Plan should provide the master with guidance to address the following:
. 1 Operational spills: The Plan should outline the procedures for removal of oil spilled and contained on deck. This may be through the use of on-board resources or by hiring a clean-up company. In either case the Plan should provide guidance to ensure proper disposal of removed oil and clean-up materials .
. 1.1 Pipe leakage: The Plan should provide specific guidance for dealing with pipe leakage .

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
either case the Plan should provide guidance to ensure proper disposal of removed oil and clean-up materials .
. 1.1 Pipe leakage: The Plan should provide specific guidance for dealing with pipe leakage .
. 1.2 Tank overflow: Procedures for dealing with tank overflows should be included. Alternatives such as lowering cargo or bunkers back to empty or slack tanks or readying pumps to transfer the excess ashore should be outlined .
. 1.3 Hull leakage: The Plan should provide guidance for responding to spillage due to suspected hull leakage. This may involve guidance on measures to be taken to reduce the head of cargo in the tank involved either by internal transfer or discharge ashore. Procedures to handle situations where it is not possible to identify the specific tank from which leakage is occurring should also be provided. Procedures for dealing with suspected hull fractures should be included and they should carry appropriate cautions regarding attention to the effect corrective actions may have on hull stress and stability.
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carry appropriate cautions regarding attention to the effect
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.2 Spills resulting from casualties: Each of the casualties listed
below should be treated in the Plan as a separate section comprised
of various checklists or other means which will ensure that the
master considers all appropriate factors when addressing the
specific casualty. These checklists must be tailored to the
specific ship. In addition to the checklists, specific personnel
assignments for anticipated tasks must be identified. Reference to
existing fire control plans and muster lists is sufficient to
identify personnel responsibilities:
. 2.1 grounding;
.2.2 fire/explosion;
.2.3 collision;
.2.4 hull failure;
.2.5 excessive list.
2 . 5.3 In addition to the checklists and personnel duty assignments mentioned
in paragraph 2.5.2, the Plan should provide the master with guidance
concerning priority actions, stability and stress considerations, and
lightening.

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
2 . 5.3 In addition to the checklists and personnel duty assignments mentioned
in paragraph 2.5.2, the Plan should provide the master with guidance
concerning priority actions, stability and stress considerations, and
lightening.
2.5.3.1 Priority actions: This section provides some general considerations
that apply to a wide range of casualties. The Plan should provide
ship-specific guidance to the master concerning these broad topics .
. 1 In responding to a casualty, the master's priority will be to ensure
the safety of personnel and the ship and to take action to prevent
escalation of the incident. In casualties involving spills,
immediate consideration should be given to measures aimed at
preventing fire and explosion, such as altering course so that the
ship is upwind of the slick, shutting down non-essential air
intakes, etc. If the ship is aground, and cannot therefore
manoeuvre, all possible sources of ignition should be eliminated
and action taken to prevent flammable vapours entering accommodation
and engine-room spaces. When it is possible to manoeuvre, the

master, in conjunction with the appropriate shore authorities,

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and action taken to prevent flammable vapours entering accommodation and engine-room spaces. When it is possible to manoeuvre, the master, in conjunction with the appropriate shore authorities, may consider moving his ship to a more suitable location in order, for example, to facilitate emergency repair work or lightening operations, or to reduce the threat posed to any particularly sensitive shoreline areas. Such manoeuvring may be subject to coastal State jurisdiction .
2 Prior to considering remedial action, the master will need to obtain detailed information on the damage sustained by his ship. A visual inspection should be carried out and all cargo tanks, bunker tanks, and other compartments sounded. Due regard should be paid to the indiscriminate opening of ullage plugs or sighting ports, especially when the ship is aground, as loss of buoyancy could result.
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. 3 Having assessed the damage sustained by the ship, the master will be in a position to decide what action should be taken to prevent

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. 3 Having assessed the damage sustained by the ship, the master will be in a position to decide what action should be taken to prevent or minimize further spillage. When bottom damage is sustained, hydrostatic balance will be achieved fairly rapidly, especially if the damage is severe, in which case the time available for preventive action will often be limited. When significant side damage is sustained in the way of oil tanks, cargo or bunkers will be released fairly rapidly until hydrostatic balance is achieved and the rate of release will then reduce and be governed by the rate at which oil is displaced by water flowing in under the oil. When the damage is fairly limited and restricted, for example, to one or two compartments, consideration may be given to transferring oil internally from damaged to intact tanks.
2.5.3.2 Stability and stress considerations: Great care in casualty response must be taken to consider stability and stress when taking actions to mitigate the spillage of oil or to free the ship if aground. The Plan should provide

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2.5.3.2 Stability and stress considerations: Great care in casualty response must be taken to consider stability and stress when taking actions to mitigate the spillage of oil or to free the ship if aground. The Plan should provide the master with detailed guidance to ensure that these aspects are properly considered. Nothing in this section shall be construed as creating a requirement for damage stability plans or calculations beyond those required by relevant international conventions .
. 1 Internal transfers should be undertaken only with a full appreciation of the likely impact on the ship's overall stress and stability. When the damage sustained is extensive, the impact of internal transfers on stress and stability may be impossible for the ship to assess. Contact may have to be made with the owner or operator or other entity in order that information can be provided so that damage stability and damaged longitudinal strength assessments may be made. These could be made within the head office technical departments. In other cases, classification societies or independent organizations may need to be contacted. The Plan should

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